ACTIVITY REPORT 2024-2025



Report by:

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Project title	**Equipping the Skills of the Adolescent girls from unorganised workers family through Vocational Trainings and empower them to attain economic sustainability by promoting Income generation activities**

Overview of the project

The project is proposed in Mugaiyur block of Villupuram district, Tamilnadu state, India which is identified as backward blocks in the parameters of poverty, education, health and industrial establishment (Ref: www.tn.gov.in/spc). The population of the proposed blocks is 196414 among them99341 are male and 97073 are female (Ref: www.censusindia.net).

11873 families are living below the poverty line in this block. Agriculture is the main occupation of these families. Due to the monsoon failure even agriculture is not the source to earn the daily bread of the people now a days. To manage the financial crisis, these people go for daily wages and some of them migrate to nearby states or city in search of jobs. Among these workers women and adolescent girls are the one who are affected most.

The workers involved in unorganized labour works in unprotected situations. These workers also migrate frequently in search of job. Because of the frequent migration, the education of the children also affected badly. Some of their children are forced to work in unsafe situation. Their capacity to think for another stable income source is very low or nil.

They could not meet their family expenses completely from the low income of these unorganised labouring. They are unable to afford the nutritious food to all the family members. Majority of these workers live in a hut in unsafe situation. They drink and use the water which is available at the working place which makes them to fall in sick frequently.

a) **Landlessness:** A major threat in the state of Tamil Nadu due to inequality in land distribution.
b) **Decline in Agriculture:** Gross cropped area is on the decline. This decline directly translated in terms of loss of output, problem of food insecurity and more importantly loss of employment. The problem got compounded further with recurrent droughts.
c) **Diversification:** The range of non-farm activities that are taking place is amazing. The income from such employment is significant for many households in the rural areas. However, only the non-poor have benefited much out of the new opportunity as compared to the poor. The resource crunch and lack of skills and social capital seriously hinder the poor from entering the non-farm sector.
d) **Education:** People in the villages highlighted the importance of education and health in their livelihoods. But there are several impediments that hinder them from accessing the infrastructure provided by the state. High dropout rates and poor attainment of higher educational levels characterize the education scenario of the poor. This is true of access to health institution as well. Low levels of educational attainment are one important reason for the inability of the poor to take advantage of the booming non-farm sector expansion. In addition, lack of skill training denies them new opportunities.
e) **Heath and sanitation:** The hygiene and sanitation are extremely poor, leading to bad health conditions and lack of access to qualified service provider.
f) **Lack of Financial Resources:** The prolonged unemployment and underemployment due to lower levels of activity in agriculture has put enormous pressure on the meagre financial resources of the poor and the poorest of the poor. The drying up of direct institutional credit has forced many poor into the hands of exploitative money lenders. The spread of SHGs have mitigated the problem to some extent.
g) **Employment:** The important livelihood has declined because of recurring drought has reduced the scope of employment in agriculture which was the main source of employment. In general the working class people lack other employability skill therefore are only eligible to go for casual labour work that is mostly available in towns namely Pondicherry or Villupuram.

By considering all these conditions of unorganised labours, this project intends to address the economic difficulty of the unorganised workers through providing vocational skill trainings to the potential girls from these families and providing them employability or promoting their own income earning activities through which the family will attain better living standards.

900 Adolescent girls from unorganized workers family between the age group of 18 to 25 years.

Direct Beneficiaries

Year	I Quarter	II Quarter	III Quarter	IV Quarter	**Total Beneficiaries**
First Year	225	225	225	225	**900**

Indirect beneficiaries of the project:

4500 Family members (900 trainees x 5 members in each family) ,

Vocational capacities of 900 adolescent girls have strengthened
Specific employability after the vocational training is ensured
Technical linkages for the establishment of Income earning activities is provided
Ensuring the sustainability of the employment or Income generation activities through proper future plans follow-ups

1. Project results

1. Community meetings and project activities orientation to the beneficiaries & Selection of beneficiaries and locations
2. Establishment of Training Centre
3. Vocational Trainings to adolescent girls on Computer, Tailoring and Typewriting skills
4. Linkages for Employment and Income Generation Activity Establishment

Achieved results	**Describe the target group reached.**	**How was this result achieved?**
1. Community meetings and project activities orientation to the beneficiaries & Selection of beneficiaries and locations	Community meeting were organised in all 63 villages. All unorganised workers and their family members were participated in the meeting in each village. Project activities were clearly explained to them. 900 adolescent girls have been finalised for the vocational Training. All the beneficiaries are in the age group between 18 - 25	Entry point meetings have been conducted in all 63 panchayats with all stakeholders and community. Beneficiaries identification is done in each village with the support of local volunteers. Initial group meetings were organised in each village and project orientation was given to them. 900 adolescent girls have been finalised for the vocational Training.
2. Establishment of Training Centre	3 training centres were established in 3 clusters to cover all 63 villages.	Common place for training centre establishment have been mobilized from local village panchayat. In order to train the adolescent girls total 63 villages were divided in to 3 clusters consisting of 21 villages in one cluster. One training centre was established in one cluster to train the girls from 21 villages. Thus 3 training centres were established in 3 clusters to cover all 63 villages. In each training centre 10 tailoring machine, 10 typewriting machine and 10 computers were purchased and installed to train the adolescent girls.
3. Vocational Trainings to adolescent girls on Computer, Tailoring and Typewriting skills	900 adolescent girls from unorganised workers family have been trained on vocation skills in this quarter. All the beneficiaries are in the age group between 18 – 25.	All the training programmes were carried out in batch mode. Each batch had 25 selected girls. In this quarter 36 batches of training was completed in all 3 disciplines (Tailoring, Typewriting and Computer) in all 3 training centres. Thus, in one year 300 girls in tailoring, 300 girls in Typewriting and 300 girls in Computer were trained. Training schedule have been made batch wise at ACT campus.

4. Linkages for Employment and Income Generation Activity Establishment	900 adolescent girls who have been trained in tailoring, Computer and Typewriting have been linked with private and government institutions for the employment and to establish their own enterprise.	ACT has approached relevant govt departments and private agencies to recruit trained girls. Also ACT has linked the interested girls with financial institutions to set up their own enterprises. Out of 900, 232 girls have got placed till date and 36 girls have started their own tailoring unit at their homes
All intended results were achieved as per the expectation through effective implementation of the project activities.		
Since the project targeted the poor adolescent girls from unorganised workers family, it created a big impact in their families in the form of getting employment and starting their own business. The income earned by these girls play a vital role in the family to manage their routine expenses and has created the habit of savings.		

2. Challenges, solutions and lessons learned

The communities which are located in nearby villages started approaching ACT to implement the same project in their village also. ACT team has organised meeting with village officials and explained the financial difficulties to execute the project in all villages.
The biggest lesson which ACT team has learned in the process of execution of the project is " When we put forth community in front in the social development projects and guide them properly on the process, The result will be more that the Target"

3. Monitoring and evaluation

ACT played the role of implementer by mobilizing the women and adolescent girls to involve in the project. ACT also mobilized govt support in getting the place for Training centre establishment. Target group is also played vital role in the implementation of the project with their fullest cooperation and arranging the things in their respective villages which all are required for the implementation of the project.
ACT staff visits the groups regularly and monitors the activities. Staffs also provide the guidance where ever it is necessary. Quarterly, Half early and Annual evaluation meeting was organised in ACT. Project staff and leaders from each workers group participated in the evaluation. The progress, outcome and the impact of the project was evaluated.

4. Durability of the project

The project is implemented in the targeted villages with the effective participation of the community. The existing CBOs have been strengthened and involved effectively in the project activities. This will make the CBOs and the stakeholders to monitor the activities, plan the future activities and leverage resources for the sustainability of the activities after the project period. Self Help groups(SHGs) are the vibrant actors in social and economic development of the villages. When SHGs are linked with the project activities they will discuss and take possible actions even after the project duration. Panchayat Raj Institution is the local level governance which handles number of schemes and programmes. Since the Linkages with Panchayat raj made strong during the project period, the proposed activities of the project will also be interlinked with the ongoing programmes of Panchayat raj after the project period in all 63 villages. During the project periods these trained girls will be very well linked with the supporting agency like govt departments, Financial institutions and other CBOs which would support the activity fullest to run without any problems.
Panchayat rajs Institution have been linked with the activities, which will be clubbed with on going schemes of the government. The Adolescent girls have been motivated to save some amount through their employment and business to meet challenging financial crisis in the future
All ACT team have been given complete orientation on the project activities. Technical people for Tailoring, Typewriting and computer have been availed from govt departments to train the staff and the target people.

5. Lobby and policy influencing

Panchayat raj Institution have been linked with the activities, which will be clubbed with on going schemes of the government. Technical people for Tailoring, Typewriting and computer have been availed from govt departments to train the staff and the target people. The Self Help Groups which are functioning in the villages have been linked with the project activities to tackle the financial crisis of the women in the future.
Technical inputs for tailoring, Typewriting and Computer training were collected from rural development department of villupuram district. Place for the establishment of training centres have been mobilized from panchayat raj department of Mugaiyur block

CASESTORIES

Annamary–Transforming Skills into Independence Beneficiary

Annamary is a 20-year-old girl from Kadaganur village in Mugaiyur block, Villupuram district, TamilNadu. She completed her education up to the10 th standard and spent her time assisting her mother with household chores. Her father is chronically ill, placing additional responsibilities on her shoulders. Despite these challenges, Annamary was determined to find opportunities to contribute to her family's income and gain personal independence.



Skill Development and Training

When ACT,with the support of Vastenactie, initiated a tailoring training program in her village, Annamaryeagerlyenrolled.Shedemonstratedremarkablededication,activelyparticipatingin all training sessions and spending extra time at the centre to practice stitching and learn new techniques. Her enthusiasm, discipline, and commitment set her apart as one of the most promising trainees in the batch.

Entrepreneurial Initiative

Recognizing her skill and dedication, a supportive villager helped Annamary acquire a brand-new tailoring machine. Empowered with both the training and equipment, she set up a small tailoring unit within a section of her home. She began stitching blouses, children's uniforms, and other garments for neighbors, gradually establishing a regular clientele.

Economic Impact

Today,Annamary earns a minimum of Rs. 700 per day from her tailoring work. This income has significantly improved her family's financial stability, allowing her to contribute meaningfully to household expenses and support her father's healthcare needs. Beyond monetary gains,Annamary has gained confidence and recognition within her community.

Personal Growth and Empowerment

Through this initiative, Annamary has transformed from a young woman assisting her family into a self-reliant entrepreneur. She expresses deep gratitude to ACT and Vastenactie for providing the skills, guidance, and opportunities necessary to stand on her own. The project has not only created a livelihood for her but also instilled a sense of empowerment and independence.

Inspiration for Others

Annamary's success story serves as an inspiring example for other women and girls in her village. It demonstrates how skill development and entrepreneurial support can help women break economic dependency, contribute to family income, and achieve personal growth, paving the way for broader social and economic empowerment.

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